



### Snape's Innermost Secrets

Alan Rickman's 27 volumes of diaries to be published as one book, in autumn 2022.  
<https://digit.in/dec20-07>



### "Please, no human teeth!"

MGM is developing a live-action/CGI hybrid "Pink Panther" movie with Jeff Fowler as the director. <https://digit.in/dec20-08>

# When love and hate collide!

The begrudgingly good, the bad and the ugly about Apple's new line of M1 chips

Boo-Man | [boo@digit.in](mailto:boo@digit.in)

**Y**es, for the three of you out there who are old enough and weird enough to have liked the band Def Leppard, this is the title of a song from their album Vault. Music trivia aside, the reason I chose this as the headline for this column is because this is how I'm left feeling after seeing what Apple's new M1 line of silicon is offering. But first, a little insight into what Apple does to my already elevated blood pressure...

It's no secret that Team Digit is made up of very varied views, which is what allows us to be so diverse in our content and expertise. However, this also means that we sometimes spend days arguing over little things, and if you were to actually walk into the office on one of those days, you'd wonder if it was a mental asylum!

One of the sorest points of contention is the Apple evangelists vs everyone else. A few members of the team no doubt have a garlanded picture of Steve Jobs at home... and it's no secret that I am NOT one of them. Every time Apple releases a financial statement, a marketing blitzkrieg (also known as a product launch), I

make it a point to ruin the collective "Oohs and aaahs" from the fanboys by saying something snarky.

This is why I hate the M1 so much. I'm so used to saying something like "Welcome to 2015!" because Apple finally adopted a feature or technology that the rest of the world has had for ages. Of course they do it in true Apple style by making their followers believe that they are the ones who somehow invented it – Apple marketing is the real fake news if you ask me.

All the while Apple are locking people into their proprietary cage by telling them lies about this fable called privacy. Yes, we're sure the iPhone is so private that no one knows anything about you... because apparently iPhone users don't use Facebook, Google or social media or products supported by advertising in general... smh! If I was called Hansel and you were Gretel, then Apple is the wicked witch tempting us with the house made of chocolate.

However, now it's my turn to be seduced by the lure of chocolate because honestly, this time the damn chocolate is too good to pass up! Thankfully I don't need a new device right this instant, and I can wait a year to see how the silicon matures and holds up to the rigours of time, but this time I have the feeling that the others just aren't going to catch up as quickly as they hoped.

When the world starts turning again after this pandemic is under control, all of us are going to be on the move again. In planes travelling for business, commuting to work on a train, or in a rideshare, working all

the time as we try and get ahead in the rat race that is life. And all of us are going to expect decent battery life and performance from our devices to enable us to do all of this, and it will not be acceptable that Apple users can get this and we cannot just because we are used to using Windows.

The other aspect of Apple that immediately turns all of us off in a heartbeat is their prices. Sorry, but there's no way we price-conscious Indians are going to pay exorbitant prices for a device that is a mere 20 per cent better than another device that costs half or even one third the price!

With a 1.2 lakh MacBook Pro you used to get far less performance than a comparable 1.2 lakh laptop from another brand. This will not be the case anymore. Apple's M1-powered Macbook Air and Pro are seemingly better in terms of battery life and multi-threaded performance for a similar priced Windows laptop.

Software compatibility is the M1's Achilles heel right now. Even with Rosetta 2, people are reporting crashes and problems across the board for apps not natively written with M1 in mind. This will get better, one assumes, but as usual, I expect to have to totally buy into the Apple system in terms of software as well. And boy is that going to hurt my pocket. Now, gamers and those who use a lot of software that runs better on Windows will probably not want to switch, and with good reason. But for those of us whose work is centered around the browser, office apps and basic image and video editing... there is no reason to avoid Apple like the plague anymore.

Of course, Apple's new chip will force Intel and AMD to up their game and drop nanometer sizes in fabs. Sadly, this too is praise for Apple, because whatever the case, it means Apple forced the industry to drastically improve... all of the begrudged compliments I'm throwing Apple's way are going to come back and bite me in the arse during the next office argument, sadly. :-(